

Please check the examination details below before entering your candidate information

|                                                                                                          |                                                                                     |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Candidate surname                                                                                        | Other names                                                                         |
| <input type="text"/>                                                                                     | <input type="text"/>                                                                |
| Centre Number                                                                                            | Candidate Number                                                                    |
| <input type="text"/> <input type="text"/> <input type="text"/> <input type="text"/> <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/> <input type="text"/> <input type="text"/> <input type="text"/> |

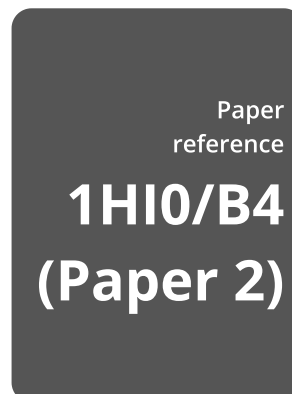
## Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9-1)

**Thursday 4 June 2026**

Morning (Time: 1 hour 50 minutes -  
total time for **both** booklets)

**History**

**BOOKLET B4: Early Elizabethan England,  
1558-88**



**You must have:**

The corresponding booklet P.

Total Marks

### Instructions

- Use **black** ink or ball-point pen.
- **Fill in the boxes** at the top of this page with your name, centre number and candidate number.
- There are two booklets in this question paper. **This is booklet B.**
- Answer questions 1(a), 1(b), 2 and **either 3 or 4** in this booklet.
- Check you have the corresponding booklet P.
- Answer the questions in the spaces provided  
- *there may be more space than you need.*

### Information

- The total mark for this booklet is 32.

- The total time for **both** booklets is 1 hour 50 minutes.
- The marks for **each** question are shown in brackets  
*- use this as a guide as to how much time to spend on each question.*
- **Do not forget to complete booklet P.**

## Advice

- Read each question carefully before you start to answer it.
- Try to divide your time equally between each booklet of the question paper.
- Check your answers if you have time at the end.

©2026 Pearson Education Ltd.

**Turn over ► Pearson**

**Early Elizabethan England, 1558-88**

**Answer Question 1(a), Question 1(b), Question 2 and EITHER Question 3 OR Question 4.**

- 1** (a) Describe one feature of the role of the Church of England in early Elizabethan society. (2)

---

---

---

---

---

---

- (b) Describe one feature of Walsingham and the use of spies. (2)

---

---

---

---

---

---

---

**(Total for Question 1 = 4 marks)**

**2 Explain why Elizabeth's religious settlement was introduced in 1559.**

(12)

You **may** use the following in your answer:

- religious divisions
- the French threat

*You **must** also use information of your own.*

Turn over ►



**(Total for Question 2 = 12 marks)**  
*Turn over ►*

**Answer EITHER Question 3 OR Question 4.**

**EITHER**

- 3** 'Walsingham and the use of spies was the main reason for the significance of Mary Queen of Scots' execution in 1587.'

How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

*You **may** use the following in your answer:*

- the Babington Plot
- the Catholic challenge

*You **must** also use information of your own.*

---

**(Total for Question 3 = 16 marks)**

**OR**

- 4** 'The drive to expand trade was the main reason for the attempted colonisation of Virginia.'

How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

*You **may** use the following in your answer:*

- new technology
- the significance of Raleigh

*You **must** also use information of your own.*

---

**(Total for Question 4 = 16 marks)**

Chosen question number: Question 3 ☐ Question 4 ☐

Page 8 of 13



This image shows a full page of a document template designed for handwritten notes or essays. It features approximately 30 evenly spaced, thin grey horizontal lines running across the width of the page. The margins are consistent on all sides, providing ample space for writing. There are no vertical lines, headers, footers, or other markings present on the page.

[illegible]

[illegible]

**TOTAL FOR BOOKLET B = 32 MARKS**

**PLEASE ENSURE YOU ALSO COMPLETE BOOKLET P.**

**BLANK PAGE**

**DO NOT WRITE ON THIS PAGE**